

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

What happens if a black cat crosses your path?



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Are you a dog person or a cat person? Why?
- If you could have special powers, which powers would you like to have? Why?

Can Do Statements

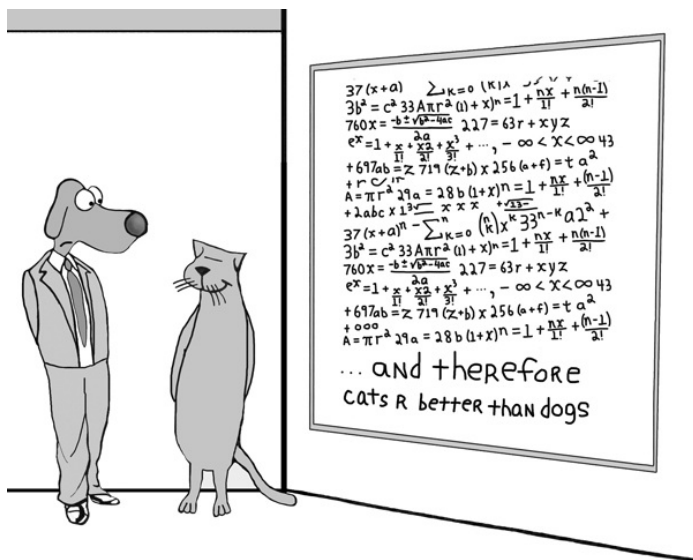
- I can talk about manners, customs and superstitions.
- I can talk about things I was supposed to do and things that were supposed to happen.
- I can talk about hypothetical situations.





Let's Explore!

Sally blogs about which cats were destined to become witches' servants.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

So when a black cat crosses your path, are you supposed to be scared? I am. -Tina from Miami.

Tina, if I had to have anything cross my path, it would be a black cat. I just love cats. The black cat superstition was mentioned several times before in the mail bag and I was supposed to write about it yesterday, but I didn't get a chance. So, I guess I'll address it now.

The black cat myth was started in the Middle Ages when people believed that black cats were servants of witches. It was even thought that witches could turn into black cats, therefore making people very unhappy when one crossed their path.

If I were a witch, I would definitely turn myself into a black cat. Black cats are such elegant creatures as opposed to smelly dogs. If I had that power, I certainly wouldn't turn into a dog. As you have guessed by now, I am not a big fan of dogs.

Another interesting belief was that kittens that were born in May were believed to be destined to become a witch's cat. Kittens are so cute in any month. So Tina, in my opinion, you are not supposed to be afraid of any black cats. If I were you, I would bring the scary cat over to my house and I will give it some nice warm milk.

Hmmm. Maybe I am a witch?





Let's Practice!

Tina and her superstitions about black cats are very interesting.

Instructions: Select the correct expression to complete the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. The black cat superstition _____ several times before.
(is mentioned / was mention / was mentioned)
2. The black cat myth _____ in the Middle Ages.
(be start / was started / is starting)
3. It _____ that witches could turn into black cats.
(was even thought / were even thought / was think)
4. Another interesting belief was that kittens that _____ in May were going to be witches' cats.
(was born / is born / were born)
5. Cats weren't supposed to _____ with milk.
(was feed / be fed)



Let's Practice!

If Sally had a cat she would feed it warm milk.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Underline the mistake. Rewrite the sentence correctly. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. If I have to have anything cross my path, it would be a black cat.

2. If I am a witch, I would definitely turn myself into a black cat.

3. If I had that power, I certainly wouldn't turned into a dog.

4. If I were you, I would brought that scary cat over to my house.

5. If I told that black cats meant bad luck, I wouldn't believe it.





Extension Activity

Write about a magical power.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, brainstorm all the powers that a witch might have.
- Answer the question: If I were a witch, what power would I like to have?
- Individually, write a paragraph (6 to 8 sentences) about your power and how you would use it.
- Write three hypothetical sentences.
- Draw a picture of you and your power.
- Share the picture and your story with a group.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I can talk about manners, customs and superstitions.

☐ ☐

I can talk about things I was supposed to do and things that were supposed to happen.

☐ ☐

I can talk about hypothetical situations.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to address** (verb): to deal with or pay attention to something
e.g. I was supposed to write about it yesterday, but I didn't get a chance. So, I guess I'll address it now.
- **as opposed to** (expression): showing contrast
e.g. Black cats are such elegant creatures as opposed to smelly dogs.
- **fan** (noun): an enthusiastic follower or admirer of a team, sport, celebrity, etc.
e.g. As you have guessed by now, I'm not a big fan of dogs.
- **elegant** (adjective): graceful, polished, or luxurious in style, design, or form
e.g. Black cats are very elegant animals.
- **to be destined** (expression): to be intended for a particular purpose
e.g. Another interesting belief was that kittens that were born in May were believed to be destined to become a witch's cat.
- **creature** (noun): anything that lives except plants
e.g. Black cats are such elegant creatures.
- **servant** (noun): a person who works for another person for little compensation
e.g. The black cat myth was started in the Middle Ages when people believed that black cats were servants of witches.



Learning Points

Be Supposed To

You use the structure **be supposed to** when you want to talk about expectations, obligations or arrangements.

You can use **be supposed to** to talk about situations in the past, present or future.

The structure is:

Subject + To be + supposed to + verb

*You **are not supposed to** be scared of witches.*

*You **are not supposed to** be scared of black cats.*

****Pronunciation tip****: When you say be supposed to, you link the /d/ and /t/ sounds together.

Like this:

Be suppose_to

Examples:

- *Are you supposed to be scared?*
- *You are not supposed to be afraid of any black cats.*
- *I was supposed to write about it yesterday.*

Conditional Sentences with *If* Clause

You use the first conditional with *if* clauses to exchange opinions about possible future outcomes.

You use the second conditional to exchange opinions about unreal or imaginary (hypothetical) situations in the future.

You use the first conditional to say it's possible that you will or will not do something. In that condition, something else may, may not will or will not happen.

The parts of the sentence are divided into two clauses: the *if* clause and the *condition* clause.

You use the second conditional to talk about hypothetical situations. There is no certainty that it's possible to fulfill the condition.

For example:

If I had a million dollars, I would buy a car.

Do you have a million dollars? No.





Learning Points

Is it possible to suddenly get a million dollars? Not really.
What would you do if you had a million dollars? Buy a car.

You use the **Simple Past verb + would**

First Conditional: 1st Clause	First Conditional: 2nd Clause	Meaning
<i>If I study today,</i>	<i>I'll go to the party tonight.</i>	It's possible that I can go to the party tonight, but only if I study first.
Second Conditional: If ... + Simple Past	Second Conditional: would + base verb	Result
<i>If I were you,</i>	<i>I would bring the cat to my house.</i>	It is an impossible situation. I am not you and this can only happen in a hypothetical situation.

Examples:

- *If I had to have anything cross my path, it would be a black cat.*
- *If I were a witch, I would definitely turn myself into a black cat.*
- *If I were you, I would bring that scary cat over to my house.*
- *If I had that power, I certainly wouldn't turn into a dog.*

